# Empire School Council Minutes
# February 14, 2024 at 6:30 PM

**LINK**

https://meet.google.com/uog-dvju-iig?authuser=0

Attendance: Candice Bauman (Empire Staff Rep.), Geoff Horsman, Laura Johnson (Treasurer), Evonne Komaromi (Secretary), Khaled Sherif (Chair), Lori Williams (Principal), Lindsay Fox (Vice-Principal)

## Welcome and Introductions

New: Geoff Horsman

## Approval of Previous Monty Meeting Minutes

Reviewed previous month's (January 2024) minutes. Laura approved minutes Khaled seconded.

## Principal / Vice Principal Report

Lindsay updated on staff transitions. Report cards go out Friday, Feb. 16, 2024. The Equity Team focus is on Black Brilliance. Tubing trip for Juniors occurred and was supported by School Council. February 7th is winter walk day. Brave Space Club are doing announcements.

Eagle of the Week (CYW initiative), also CYW leadership initiatives continue.

Go Girls started last week (11-13 years old girls) healthy and active living through Big Brothers Big Sisters.

## Update on Arts Night

Lori created form but has not shared with staff yet. April 17th is for STEM night, early March/mid April possible for Arts Night. The Literacy night will be immediately after school and Arts Night will be later (5:30 p.m.) and STEM would be earlier (perhaps 4:00-4:30 p.m.).

Action: Lori will send out form to Empire staff to see what staff support is available and input from staff. Music support from staff. Empire would be interested to have snow sculptor return and will see what availability and if weather conditions are amenable.

Lori will have School Council sign up to support various activities. Possible Empire clubs/groups to lead other activities.

## Royal Basketball and Artshine being Offered at Empire

WRDSB Facilities approves school building rentals and school rentals do not go through Lori.

Action: Evonne can research Artshine and let the School Council know what she finds out.

**Quest STEM night Update and PRO Grant Update**

PRO Grant was approved for $2000.00. For 300 students it will cost $1800.00 for Quest to host activities. For remaining $200.00 Quest could add some activities. Quest activities are for Grade 1-6. Empire would be tasked with managing registration. The event is two hours and on Wed. April 17, 2024 possibly 4:30 – 6:30 p.m. Only students attending Empire P.S. can participate.

Action: Lori will talk to Empire Head Secretary as to how registration could occur. It could occur with a physical copy, translated copies and School Day. Supervision and additional activities will be needed for kindergarten children. Khaled will ask Quest what the price breakdown is in case registration is over 300 students.

**Safe, Caring and Inclusive (SCIS) Team at Empire**

Team has met twice and is driven by students. Parent rep. Lindsay Blashill and CYW (Jillian Gilmour) and teacher (Peter Pettit). The project that was chosen was to paint on wall bricks the country flag to represent the nationality of every person in the building. Students will need to do a Google Form to find out every nation represented and plan the art component in the actual painting of the building. They are also in charge of the Pink Shirt Day (announcements, anti—bullying messages, order pink shirt stickers, slide deck to share with each class, picture books, quotes). This group will meet tomorrow. SOAR assembly in March will include SCIS students. When students come into the assembly learning a new greeting in various languages.

Equity Team (Team consists of adults): Living library, why does it feel like home and greetings as students walk in.

The two teams will meet together.

MDI WRDSB data collection every year and is shared with the staff as a team.

Evonne asked if this data could be available on a school website as suggested on https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/ under ‘How can parents/guardians be engaged with SCIS at their child’s school?’ Point 2 ‘School Climate Surveys’: “Request that the school climate survey be available on the school’s website”. Lori will research if this is possible.

**Update on Installing Soccer Goals at Empire**

Khaled researched for a supplier of soccer goals and is waiting for replies from City staff. The goal posts will be pulled out and new posts will be put in. Lines on the field need to be painted on.

**Parent Questions and Concerns**

Geoff had a question as to whether OSIE (Ontario Institute for Studies in Education) could come and present to the parent/guardian Empire community. Lori responded that some changes pertaining to education that occur are specific to the WRDSB. The Literacy night will help answer some of the local education WRDSB directives. Lori would like to further plan how we could continue to engage with this goal of parental/guardian engagement and how and what is being taught at Empire P.S. Lori would like to know what OSIE would share and make sure all parents in the diversity represented in the Empire P.S. would benefit from such an OSIE presentation. Geoff will investigate details and will present at the next meeting.

**Adjournment**

Next Meeting: Wed. March 20th, 2024 6:30 p.m. or another date if Staff meeting date coincides.

Laura approved and Evonne seconded.